

HOYT J. LONG

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Employment

- *University of Chicago*, Department of East Asian Languages & Civilizations, July 2011–
Andrew W. Mellon Professor of Japanese Literature and Digital Studies
- *Bard College*, Division of Languages & Literatures, Annandale-on-Hudson, NY, 2007–2011
Assistant Professor of Japanese Literature and Language

Academic Background

PhD, 2007 **Japanese Literature**, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor.

BA, 1998 **Japanese (Major), Computer Science (Minor)**, University of Oregon, Eugene.

Recent Publications (Selected)

- “[Spoiler Alert: Narrative Forecasting as a Metric for Tension in LLM Storytelling](#),” with multiple authors, *Conference on Language Modeling* (2026).
- “Large Language Models as Cultural Agents: Author, Teacher, Reader,” with Richard Jean So (forthcoming, *Modern Fiction Studies*)
- “[Critical Confabulation: Can LLMs Hallucinate for Social Good?](#),” with Patrick Sui, Eamon Duede, and Richard Jean So, *Proceedings of the 2026 International Conference on Learning Representations* (2026).
- “[What does AI do for Cultural Interpretation?](#) A Randomized Experiment on Close Reading Poems with Exposure to AI Interpretation,” with Jiayin Zhu, Mina Lee, and Richard Jean So, *Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems* (2026).
- “[Computational Hermeneutics: Evaluating Generative AI as a Cultural Technology](#),” with multiple authors, *Frontiers in Artificial Intelligence* (Winter 2026).
- “[Why Slop Matters](#),” with multiple authors, *ACM AI Letters* (January 2026).
- “[The Social AI Author](#): Modeling Creativity and Distinction in Simulated Cultural Fields,” with Teddy Roland and Richard Jean So, *AI & Society* (December 2025).
- “New Towers of Babel: Faith and Doubt in the Future of Translation,” invited contribution to *Poetics Today* 45.2, “AI/ChatGPT” special issue (June 2024).
- “[We Want Our Catastrophe TV](#),” invited contribution to *Public Books*, “Hacking the Culture Industries” special section (November 2023).
- “[#COVID, Crisis, and the Search for Story in the Platform Age](#),” with Richard Jean So and Kaitlyn Todd, *Critical Inquiry* (Summer 2023).
- “[Learning to Live with Machine Translation](#),” *New Literary History*, special issue on Culture, Theory, and Data (Autumn 2022/Winter 2023).
- [The Values in Numbers: Reading Japanese Literature in a Global Information Age](#), Columbia University Press, 2021.
- *On Uneven Ground: Miyazawa Kenji and the Making of Place in Modern Japan*, Stanford University Press, 2012.

Recent Fellowships, Awards, Honors

- *Co-Investigator*, “Understanding Human Storytelling through the Limits of Generative AI,” development grant of \$26,000 awarded by HAVI program, Schmidt Sciences, 2026.
- *Co-Investigator*, “Humanistic AI: Reimagining Humanistic Pursuits in the Age of Generated Media,” \$50,000, granted by Neubauer Family Collegium for Culture and Society, 2025.
- *Co-Investigator*, “Literature in the Age of Artificial Intelligence,” \$54,190 (CAD), granted by Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council of Canada, 2024-2026.
- *Co-Investigator*, “The Platform Era: New Approaches to the Study of Global Culture,” \$29,200 granted by the Franke Institute for the Humanities, 2022-2024.
- *Co-Investigator*, “Black Book Interactive Project III,” \$350,000 granted by the National Endowment of the Humanities, 2021-2023.
- *Mellon New Directions Fellowship*, Mellon Foundation, 2016-2019.

Computational Training and Workshops

- *Japanese Text Mining Workshop*. Instructor and Co-Organizer. University of Chicago, 2021
- *Summer Program for Quantitative Methods, Interuniversity Consortium for Political and Social Research*, University of Michigan, 2015 and 2021.
- *Certificate in Natural Language Technology*, three quarter sequence in NLP and machine learning methods. University of Washington, Summer 2016-Winter 2017.

Research Collaborations and Digital Projects

- *Advisory Board*, UChicago AI Pillar on Human-Machine Creativity, 2026-Present.
- *Advisory Board*, [UChicago Node Project](#), University of Chicago. NEH funded project at the University of Chicago, 2024-2025.
- *Advisory Board*, [Scholar-Curated Worksets for Analysis, Re-use, and Dissemination](#), Mellon funded project at HathiTrust Research Center, 2020-2022.
- *Co-Director*, [Textual Optics Lab](#), University of Chicago. 2017-Present.
- *Project Partner*, [Black Books Interactive Project](#), an ACLS and NEH supported project at the University of Kansas and in collaboration with Textual Optics Lab. 2015-2022.

Service to Professional Organizations

- Advisory Board Member, *Computational Humanities Research*
- Editorial Board Member, *Japanese Journal of Digital Humanities*
- Editorial Board Member, *CA: The Journal of Cultural Analytics*
- Editorial Board Member, *Journal of Social and Cultural Possibilities*
- Consultant for Authors Alliance and Samuelson Law, Technology, and Public Policy Clinic on matters related to securing exemptions from copyright for text and data mining.

Professional Memberships

- Association for Asian Studies (AAS), Association for Japanese Literary Studies (AJLS), Japan Association of Digital Humanities (JADH), Modern Language Association (MLA)